THE CATCH

RULEBOOK — HOW TO PLAY

PLAYERS	ROUNDS	TIME	YOU NEED
2 – 6	7 matches	20 – 40 min	The deck + 1 phone

The Catch is a dating card game with a phone for a matchmaker. The phone shows who's on the market. The cards hold their secrets. Peek, bluff, date or ghost, then flip the cards, add them up, and find out who you really went home with.

DATE GHOST STALK TRAIT CARDS

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SET UP & PLAY

IN THE BOX

68 trait cards	Green, yellow and red flags, plus 4 dealbreakers
6 blank cards	3 green (+2) and 3 red (−2) to write your own
2 rules cards	How to play, on two cards
30 stalk chips	3 per player
How-to sheet	One page that folds into the box
One phone	bymayawalsh.design → The Catch → Keep Score. No app, no login.

SETUP

A **Who's playing**

Open the scorekeeper and tap **START**. Pick who you're **looking for** (girls, guys or everyone), then add **2–6 players**, each with a name and a player type (page 3).

B **Write your own (optional)**

Write real behaviors on the blank cards and shuffle them in. Green blanks are +2, red blanks are −2.

C **Set the table**

Shuffle the deck face-down in the middle. Give everyone 3 stalk chips. Press START THE GAME.

EACH MATCH

1 **Meet them**

The phone shows who's on the market: name, age and archetype.

2 **Deal**

Deal **6 cards**: **2 face-up**, **4 face-down**. Those six cards are this person.

3 **Stalk**

Spend a chip to secretly peek at one face-down card, then put it back. Everyone sees you stalk; nobody sees what you found. A face-down dealbreaker (−10) can sink a whole date.

4 **Decide**

On 3, everyone says **DATE** or **GHOST** out loud. You have 3 ghosts; when they're gone, you have to date.

5 **Flip, add up & enter**

Flip every card. If you dated, add up all 6 **using your type** and enter your total on the phone. If you ghosted, tap Ghosted. Discard the six cards.

SCORING

CARD	VALUE
Green flag	+1 to +3
Yellow flag	0 to −1
Red flag	−2 to −3
Dealbreaker	−10

Blank cards: +2 (green) or −2 (red).

PLAYER TYPES · YOUR TYPE CHANGES WHAT EACH CARD IS WORTH TO YOU

The Romantic — every green flag is worth 1 more

The Chaotic One — negative cards get +2 (never above 0)

The Avoidant — +3s are worth 1 less, −2 and worse cost 1 more

The Selective — every negative card costs 1 more

The Overthinker — a −1 counts as −3, a 0 as −1

The Gold Digger — +2 and up are worth 1 more, −2 and worse cost 1 more

THE PHONE ADDS THESE FOR YOU

Total −5 or worse	Red flag: lose 2 more
Total 7 or more	Chemistry: +2, only if you were the only one who dated them
The catfish	One secret profile in matches 2–5, revealed after scoring. Dated it: −4. Ghosted it: +1.

AFTER MATCH 7 · HIGHEST TOTAL WINS, TIES ARE SHARED · EVERYONE GETS A TITLE

18 or more	The Catch
10 – 17	The Romantic
1 – 9	The Situationship
0 or less	The Red Flag Magnet

QUICK REFERENCE

EACH PLAYER

Starts with	0 points
Ghosts	3
Stalk chips	3
Player type	1, for the whole game

WHO DOES WHAT

The table	Deal, stalk, decide out loud, flip, add up
The phone	Profiles, bonuses, catfish, standings, titles
Deck runs out	Reshuffle the discards

TIPS

1 **Watch who stalks**

The peek is secret, but the chip isn't. Someone stalked and then ghosted? They probably found a red flag.

2 **Bluff your peeks**

Found a +3? Hesitate. Found a −10? Look pleased. Your face is a card too.

3 **Save ghosts for the worst**

You only get 3. Don't spend them on profiles that might be fine.

4 **Chase chemistry**

A great date only earns +2 if you're the only one who went.

5 **Know your type's math**

Before you say Date, count the cards your type changes.

6 **Add up fast**

Add the printed values, then fix only the cards your type changes. Say your total out loud before you enter it.

PLAY AGAIN

Shuffle everything back together and press PLAY AGAIN: seven new profiles, a new catfish, and a chance to change your title.